

Cover Letter

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Dear Airbnb Hiring Team,

Airbnb's operations scale is exactly the kind of environment where AIOps stops being a buzzword and starts being the difference between reactive firefighting and genuine operational leverage. That's the problem I've been solving for the past decade, and it's why this role caught my attention.

I'm currently architecting autonomous Agentic SRE pipelines that use LLMs for root-cause analysis - not as a proof-of-concept, but as production infrastructure designed to reduce human toil and accelerate resolution. That work maps directly to the AIOps vision and observability platform strategy you're building at Airbnb.

A few things I'd bring on day one:

I've built observability platforms with distributed tracing from the ground up - implementing a New Relic stack that cut MTTR by 50% across a microservices environment handling 10M+ requests per day. I understand what it takes to move from reactive alerting to correlated, actionable insights at scale.

I've written the automation that actually ships. Python and Go tooling I built eliminated 80+ hours of monthly toil and tripled deployment velocity. These weren't one-off scripts - they were maintained, tested, production-grade tools built for durability.

I've led cross-team technical initiatives end-to-end, including incident command, postmortem accountability, and driving corrective actions that stick. I know the difference between writing a postmortem and actually closing the loop.

My infrastructure background spans AWS, Azure, and GCP, with deep experience in Kubernetes, IaC with Terraform, CI/CD pipelines, and event-driven architectures. I've architected and operated large-scale AKS environments for ML model training and serving - so I understand both the AI side and the infrastructure that has to support it reliably.

What draws me to Airbnb specifically is the combination of a homegrown observability platform, a genuine commitment to AIOps strategy, and the complexity of supporting global infrastructure at this scale. That's a meaningful technical challenge, and the kind of environment where I do my best work.

I'd welcome the conversation.

Josef Doornink